

Rewriting the Commit History

If you've accidentally committed a file that contains sensitive information, such as passwords, API keys, or credit card numbers, it's not enough to edit that information out and make a new commit. Anyone with access to the repo, either on your computer or cloned remotely, could roll back to the commit that includes this info.

Actually removing this information from your repo so it's unrecoverable is tricky but possible. The exact steps are beyond the scope of this book, but you can use either the `git filter-branch` command or, preferably, the BFG Repo-Cleaner tool. You can read about both at <https://help.github.com/en/articles/removing-sensitive-data-from-a-repository>.

The easiest preventative measure for this problem is to have a *secrets.txt*, *confidential.py*, or similarly named file where you place sensitive, private information, and add it to *.gitignore* so you'll never accidentally commit it to the repo. Your program can read this file for the sensitive info instead of having the sensitive info directly in its source code.

GitHub and the git push Command

Although Git repos can exist entirely on your computer, many free websites can host clones of your repo online, letting others easily download and contribute to your projects. The largest of these sites is GitHub. If you keep a clone of your project online, others can add to your code, even if the computer from which you develop is turned off. The clone also acts as an effective backup.

NOTE

Although the terms can cause confusion, Git is version control software that maintains a repo and includes the `git` command, whereas GitHub is a website that hosts Git repos online.

Go to <https://github.com> and sign up for a free account. From the GitHub home page or your profile page's Repositories tab, click the **New** button to start a new project. Enter **wizcoin** for the repository name and the same